

Application Q&A: Guild.ai, Product Manager

Pre-filled answers for the Ashby application form and likely screen-1 questions. Same human-tone rules as the resume.

Why Guild.ai?

I have spent the last six months building the customer-side version of what Guild is shipping. At ESC Partners I owned **Maya AI** from vision to launch in **2.5 months**: an autonomous, event-driven agent platform on Oracle CCS that runs across voice, chat, SMS, email, and mobile for a **200K-resident utility**. The agent acts on its own when confident; when it is not, a supervisor sees the draft in Microsoft Teams and decides with one click. That supervisor cockpit is the local version of a control plane (identity, audit, takeover, observability) built for one customer at a time.

Guild is the same problem at platform scale. Every enterprise that wants to put agents into production needs the centralized identity, least-privilege access, immutable audit log, and cost visibility you are building. The Agent Hub also speaks to me because the agentic workflows I have shipped at ESC (Maya AI plus the Conference Outreach pipeline) are exactly the kind of builds the Hub is meant to host: open, builder-first, governed by default. The role description reads like the next logical step after Maya AI.

The funding context matters too. The **\$44M Series A** from Khosla, GV, NFX, and Acrew gives Guild the runway to define this category properly. I want to be the first PM in that room.

Why this role?

The Product Manager seat at Guild names four things I already do every day:

1. **Own the product surface end-to-end.** I owned Maya AI from vision to NEP launch in 2.5 months, including the supervisor cockpit, the email triage spinoff, and seventeen admin APIs.
2. **Be the voice of the customer.** Customer discovery at ESC means sitting with utility supervisors, watching them work in Oracle CCS, and translating their pain into INVEST stories.
3. **Translate ambiguity into action.** I joined ESC with no PM playbook for AI. I wrote the backlog, the eval framework, the UAT process, and the supervisor onboarding flow. The team had not shipped AI before. They have now.
4. **Collaborate, build, and ship.** I prototype on Claude Code daily. The "build the thing" part of the JD is literal for me.

The next logical step for the work I already do is to do it at platform scale, on a team where the founders are themselves builders. Guild qualifies.

Tell me about a time you took something from zero to one.

Maya AI is the cleanest example. ESC had no AI track when I joined. The CRO wanted Oracle CCS to be smarter, faster, and multi-channel. There was no design doc, no eval framework, no team.

I started with two weeks of customer discovery at NEP. Sat with supervisors. Watched them dig through Oracle CCS to answer a single resident question. Mapped the workflow. Found the failure points: language barriers, response time, manual data entry, no escalation path.

I wrote a one-page product narrative. Picked the stack: AWS Bedrock for model routing, n8n for workflow orchestration, FastAPI for the integration layer, React for the supervisor cockpit, Microsoft Teams adaptive cards for the human-in-the-loop approval, 11 Labs for the 26-language voice surface.

I built it on Claude Code, end-to-end, in **2.5 months**. Single AI hire. Maya AI is now live at NEP with **200K+ residents**, rolling out at Moreno Valley Electrical, piloting at Delta Utilities. It handles **70 to 80%** of first-touch support autonomously and removes **100+** manager emails per day. Projected savings at NEP are around **\$225K per month**.

Founder mentality is not a phrase from a posting for me. It is how I worked when I was bootstrapping CloudApproach. It is how I work now.

What is your biggest accomplishment?

Two answers, depending on the lens.

Career-wise: Bootstrapping and selling CloudApproach plus Approachables for **\$575K combined**. Two ventures across UK and MENA, **200+ agency clients**, **80+ real-estate partners**, **\$5M+** in deals influenced, **95% client retention** post-acquisition. Two exits before I turned 25.

Last six months: Maya AI live at NEP with **200K+ residents** in **2.5 months** as the sole AI on staff. The team had never shipped AI before. They have shipped it now.

Why are you leaving your current role?

I am not leaving for cause. I am leaving for scope and stage. ESC has been a great place to ship Maya AI, but the next step is a builder-first AI platform company where the product I help define touches every enterprise that puts agents into production. Guild is the team I want to do that with.

What are your compensation expectations?

The posted range at Guild (\$220K to \$320K base plus equity plus bonus) is in line with what I am looking for. I would lean into the equity conversation given the stage and how directly my work would shape the platform. Open to discussing structure once we are aligned on scope.

When can you start?

Immediately. I would give ESC two weeks for a clean handoff on Maya AI's roadmap and supervisor cockpit, but I am ready to start day-one work in parallel.

Are you authorized to work in the United States?

I am on STEM OPT (F-1 visa) through 2027 and am H-1B eligible. I would file in the next cycle. Happy to walk through timing in our first conversation.

How did you hear about this role?

Found through Ashby. Guild scored highest against my criteria of role, stage, and product, so I applied same day.

Open to relocation?

Yes. Open to San Francisco. Can be on-site within 30 days of offer.

Anything else you want us to know?

Three proof links if you want to see the work:

- SALL live: ai-sales-assistant-frontend.onrender.com
- SALL walkthrough: youtube.com/watch?v=eCkP7_ZI348
- Portfolio: shivamsportfolio.webflow.io

Happy to walk through a code-level Maya AI dive at any point in the loop.